

B2 Reading

New Generation English · Academic diagnostic

Reading

Digital attention and the illusion of productivity

Schools often introduce digital platforms with the promise of efficiency. Assignments can be submitted instantly, feedback can be stored, and parents can see progress without waiting for a meeting. Yet efficiency is not the same as learning. A student may move quickly through online tasks while paying only partial attention. Notifications, open tabs and the habit of checking messages can turn a thirty-minute assignment into a sequence of interruptions.

The problem is not technology itself but the absence of attention training. Students are often told to be responsible online, but they are rarely taught what responsibility looks like in practical terms. A well-designed digital task should include a goal, a time limit, a pause for checking understanding and a short reflection. Without these elements, a platform may produce the appearance of independent work while quietly weakening concentration. The most successful learners are not those who use the most tools, but those who know when to close them.

Questions

1. What distinction does the text make?
 - A. Efficiency is not the same as learning.
 - B. Parents dislike digital platforms.
 - C. Online tasks are always useless.

Answer: _____

2. What can interrupt online work?

- A. Notifications and open tabs.
- B. Books and pencils.
- C. Teacher feedback.

Answer: _____

3. What is the central problem?

- A. Lack of attention training.
- B. Technology itself.
- C. Too much handwriting.

Answer: _____

4. What should a digital task include?

- A. Goal, time limit, checking and reflection.
- B. Only speed and points.
- C. A long list of apps.

Answer: _____

5. What does appearance of independent work mean?

- A. It may look productive without deep focus.
- B. It is always excellent.
- C. It is impossible to observe.

Answer: _____

6. Who are the most successful learners?

- A. Those who know when to close tools.
- B. Those with the newest devices.
- C. Those who never use technology.

Answer: _____

7. Which tone best describes the text?

- A. Balanced and critical.
- B. Angry and dismissive.
- C. Purely promotional.

Answer: _____

8. What can be inferred about digital platforms?

- A. They need method, not blind use.
- B. They should be banned.
- C. They replace teachers completely.

Answer: _____